

General Instructions:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

- 1. This question paper comprises of 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.*
- 2. The question paper contains THREE sections – Section – A: Reading Skills; Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills; Section – C: Literature Textbook.*
- 3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.*

SECTION A: READING SKILLS (20 marks)

1. Read the following text.

(10 Marks)

The Impact of Technology on Youngsters

(1) The rapid growth of technology has dramatically changed how young people interact with the world. From social media platforms to video games, smart phones, and online education, technology plays a significant role in the daily lives of youngsters. While the benefits of technology are undeniable, there are also several negative impacts that must be acknowledged.

(2) One of the most significant concerns is the effect of excessive screen time. Many youngsters spend hours glued to their devices, leading to sedentary lifestyles. This lack of physical activity is linked to a rise in obesity and related health issues such as diabetes and cardiovascular diseases. Additionally, prolonged exposure to screens can lead to eye strain, headaches, and disrupted sleep patterns.

(3) Social media platforms can also have a detrimental impact on mental health. Constantly being exposed to curated images and idealized lifestyles can create feelings of inadequacy and fuel anxiety or depression. Cyber bullying is another growing concern, as it has become easier for individuals to target others behind the anonymity of a screen.

(4) Despite these drawbacks, technology also brings numerous opportunities. Online education platforms allow students to access information from across the globe, enhancing learning opportunities. Social media, when used responsibly, can foster connections and raise awareness about important issues. Video games, once considered purely recreational, are now recognized for improving cognitive skills and hand-eye coordination.

(5) Ultimately, the key to managing the impact of technology lies in balance. Parents, educators, and youngsters themselves need to establish healthy boundaries that allow them to benefit from technological advances without falling into the traps of overuse.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. How might the rise in technology use among youngsters contribute to long-term public health issues? (1)

II. Complete the statement, with the correct option from the two given below: (1)

Social media can create feelings of _____

- a) inadequacy and fuel anxiety or depression.
- b) well-being and success in this fast and modern world.

III. Support the writer's idea that Social media platforms can also have a detrimental impact on mental health. (2)

IV. Select the option that best reflects the fact that video games are no longer considered recreational. (1)

- a) Video games make youngsters spend hours glued to their devices, leading to sedentary lifestyles.
- b) Video games are now recognized for improving cognitive skills and hand-eye coordination

V. State whether the following statement is True or False. (1)

“Cyberbullying is no longer an issue in the age of technology.”

VI. What is a health risk linked to excessive screen time? (1)

- (i) Improved physical health
- (ii) Cancer
- (iii) Disrupted sleep patterns
- (iv) Higher physical fitness level

VII. Why is it important to manage the amount of time spent on social media? (2)

VIII. Fill in the blank with the correct option from those given. In the phrase ‘being exposed to curated images,’ the word ‘curated’ refers to _____. (1)

- a. crude b. organised c. unrefined d. flawed

2. Read the following text:

(10 Marks)

The New Education Policy (NEP) 2020

The New Education Policy (NEP) 2020, introduced by the Government of India, aims to transform the Indian educational landscape by promoting holistic and multidisciplinary education. One of the key aspects of the NEP is the emphasis on vocational training and skill development.

Key Features of NEP 2020	Description
School Education	Introduction of the National Educational Technology Forum (NETF) for teacher training.
Vocational Education	Integration of vocational subjects at the secondary level.
Higher Education	Multidisciplinary approach allowing students to choose subjects across streams.
National Educational Technology Forum	A platform for educational technology integration and innovation.

The table outlines some of the key features of the NEP 2020. The integration of vocational education at the secondary level is particularly significant, aiming to bridge the gap between education and employment. By 2025, the government aims to increase the Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER) in higher education to **50%**, promoting inclusivity and access to quality education.

The NEP also highlights the need for digital infrastructure in schools, which has become increasingly important in light of the COVID-19 pandemic. Through these initiatives, the policy seeks to create a robust educational framework that equips students with the skills and knowledge required for future challenges.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above:

I. What is one of the main objectives of the NEP 2020? (1)

- A) To decrease the number of vocational subjects
- B) To enhance access to quality education
- C) To eliminate digital infrastructure in schools
- D) To increase dropout rates

II. Select the option that is true for the assertion and reason given below. (1)

Assertion: Multidisciplinary education is a core feature of the NEP 2020.

Reason: The NEP allows students to choose subjects across different streams, promoting a multidisciplinary approach.

- A. Both the assertion and reason are true, and the reason is the correct explanation of the assertion.
- B. Both the assertion and reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.
- C. The assertion is true, but the reason is false.
- D. The assertion is false, but the reason is true.

III. Identify the word that is used for the combination of different academic disciplines or subjects that allows students to learn across various fields. (1)

IV. Provide a reason for the NEP's emphasis on digital infrastructure in schools. (1)

V. Read the given prompt and select the correct option in the brackets to fill in the blank. (1)

The NEP emphasizes that vocational education will be introduced at the ____ level in schools to better prepare students for employment.
(secondary / primary / higher)

VI Explain the significance of the Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER) target set by the NEP. (1)

VII. Complete the sentence suitably. (1)

The NEP aims to transform education by focusing on multidisciplinary learning, allowing students to _____, encouraging flexibility and creativity in their education.

VIII. Complete the following with a suitable reason. (1)

The integration of vocational education is considered crucial in secondary level because _____ .

IX. How does the NEP 2020 aim to promote multidisciplinary education, and why is it important? (2)

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR (20 Marks)

GRAMMAR (10 Marks)

3. Complete any ten of twelve of the following tasks, as directed:

I. Fill in the blank with the correct option to complete the opening line of a formal letter:

Dear Mr. Lee,

We regret to inform you that due to unforeseen circumstances, the scheduled meeting on Friday has been _____ to next Wednesday.

A) postponed B) canceled C) rescheduled D) confirmed

II Read the given sentence from a marketing report. Identify the error and supply the correction in the given format. (1)

"The company's sales has increased by 20% in the last quarter."

ERROR	CORRECTION
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III. Priya asked the following question to her colleague, Dinesh. 1

"Will the sales report be ready by Friday?"

Report Priya's question correctly

IV Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete an official announcement.

Notice to all staff: (This/ These/ That) meeting scheduled for tomorrow has been postponed due to unforeseen circumstances. (1)

V. Read Aisha's reply to her colleague, regarding the meeting schedule. "I'm available on Friday at 2 PM." Report Aisha's reply by completing the sentence correctly. (1)

Aisha informed her colleague _____.

VI. Identify and correct the error in the given line taken from an online news report: (1)

"The company have launched their new product."

VII. Complete the given school announcement by selecting the correct option to fill in the blank. (1)

The school administration ____ a special assembly to honor the achievements of the graduating class.

A. has organized B. organize C. will organize D. had organized

VIII. Detect the error and supply the correction for the given observation by a child. (1)

The teacher give us homework every day.

IX Report the dialogue between a teacher and a student, by completing sentence. (1)

Teacher: Can you explain the concept of climate change?

Student: Sure, it's the long-term warming of the planet.

The teacher asked the student to explain the concept of climate change, and the student _____.

X. Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from a handbook for managers. Effective communication is key to resolving conflicts; therefore, team leaders ____ listen actively to their team members. (1)

A. must B. should C. will D. can

XI. Complete the given sentence about the reaction of some friends, by selecting the correct option: (1)

1. The majority of students _____ interested in attending the seminar.

A. is B. are C. has D. have

XII Read the conversation about social media, between a teacher and a student: (1)

Teacher: What impact does social media have on mental health?

Student: It can exacerbate anxiety and depression. Report the student's response by completing the following

The student explained that social media _____ anxiety and depression.

WRITING NOTE: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

4 A.] You are Radha Kumari, a concerned citizen from Aluva, Bengaluru. Compose a letter in about 120 words, to the Municipal Commissioner of your city, complaining about the growing issue of uncollected garbage in your locality. Highlight its health impacts and suggest measures like increased frequency of garbage collection, penalties for littering, and community clean-up drives.

OR

4 B] You are Ram Sharma of Manek Road, Mumbai. Write a letter in about 120 words addressing the Manager of a mobile service provider Fiber Net, complaining about frequent network disruptions in your area. Explain how this affects communication and productivity and request immediate action to improve the quality of service by upgrading infrastructure.

5 A] Read the product details on a water bottle:

1. Made from BPA-free, durable stainless steel
2. Double-wall vacuum insulation keeps beverages cold for 24 hours and hot for 12 hours
3. Leak-proof cap with easy carry handle
4. Available in various sizes and colours.

Analyse why this water bottle would be a smart purchase, considering its safety, durability, functionality, and design options. Write the analytical paragraph in 120 words. (OR)

5 B] Read the given details of a community library intended for your neighborhood:

1. Shelves arranged in a circular design for easy browsing
2. Sections for different age groups, including a children's area with interactive learning tools
3. Quiet reading corners with comfortable chairs
4. Access to digital resources, including e-books and audiobooks
5. Weekly storytelling sessions for kids.

Analyse the details and write an analytical paragraph in about 120 words focusing on how the library is suitable for diverse community needs, including access to knowledge, comfort, and engagement for different age groups.

SECTION D: LITERATURE TEXTBOOK (40 marks)

6)Read the given extracts and answer any one of the two questions given below:

6 A.] "Ramlal stood rooted to the ground, his head bowed low with the weight of grief and shame. The flames of the sacred fire slowly died down. Everyone was gone. Ramlal turned to Bholi and said, "But what about you, no one will ever marry you now. What shall we do with you?" And Sulekha said in a voice that was calm and steady, "Don't you worry, Pitaji! In your old age I will serve you and Mother, and I will teach in the same school where I learnt so much. Isn't that right, Ma'am?" The teacher had all along stood in a corner, watching the drama. "Yes, Bholi, of course," she replied. And in her smiling

eyes was the light of a deep satisfaction that an artist feels when contemplating the completion of her masterpiece.

I. What emotion does Ramlal's bowed head convey in the given scene? (1)

- A. Anger B. Grief and shame C. Resignation D. Indifference

II. How does Bholi's response to her father's concerns demonstrate her growth and self-awareness? (1)

- A. She becomes defensive and aggressive B. She remains silent and submissive
C. She shows determination and independence D. She displays frustration and despair

III. Fill in the blank: The teacher's "smiling eyes" and words of affirmation suggest that she feels a sense of _____ towards Bholi. (1)

- A. responsibility B. pride C. disappointment D. detachment

IV. What contrast does the teacher's calm demeanor provide in the scene? (1)

- A. To Ramlal's anxiety and Bholi's confidence B. To the chaos and noise of the surrounding environment
C. To the intensity of the sacred fire D. To the other characters' cruelty and indifference

V. What symbolic significance does the "completion of her masterpiece" have in relation to the teacher's role in Bholi's life?1

- A. It represents the teacher's failure
B. It symbolizes the teacher's pride in Bholi's growth
C. It indicates the teacher's detachment from Bholi
D. It signifies the teacher's disappointment in Bholi's choices

6 B] CHUBUKOV : My dear fellow, whom do I see! Ivan Vassilevitch! I am extremely glad! [Squeezes his hand] Now this is a surprise, my darling... How are you?

LOMOV: Thank you. And how may you be getting on?

CHUBUKOV: We just get along somehow, my angel, thanks to your prayers, and so on. Sit down, please do... Now, you know, you shouldn't forget all about your neighbors, my darling. My dear fellow, why are you so formal in your get-up! Evening dress, gloves, and so on. Can you be going anywhere, my treasure?

LOMOV: No. I've come only to see you, honored Stepan Stepanovitch.

CHUBUKOV: Then why are you in evening dress, my precious? As if you're paying a New Year's Eve visit!

LOMOV: Well, you see, it's like this. [Takes his arm] I've come to you, honoured Stepan Stepanovitch, to trouble you with a request. Not once or twice have I already had the privilege of applying to you for help, and you have always, so to speak... I must ask your pardon, I am getting excited. I shall drink some water, honoured Stepan Stepanovitch

1. What tone does Chubukov's greeting convey, in the conversation? (1)

- | | |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| A. Formal and reserved | B. Warm and enthusiastic |
| C. Sarcastic and mocking | D. Indifferent and neutral |

II. Analyze Lomov's response to Chubukov's question about his formal attire. What does it reveal about Lomov's character? (1)

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A. He is nervous and anxious | B. He is confident and self-assured |
| C. He is careless and irresponsible | D. He is shy and introverted |

III. Fill in the blank: Chubukov addresses Lomov as "my darling" and "my precious" to convey a sense of _____. (1)

- | | | | |
|------------|--------------|--------------|------------|
| A. respect | B. affection | C. annoyance | D. sarcasm |
|------------|--------------|--------------|------------|

IV. What does Lomov's request to drink water suggest about his emotional state? (1)

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|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| A. He is calm and composed | B. He is excited and enthusiastic |
| C. He is nervous and agitated | D. He is bored and disinterested |

V. If Lomov has come to Chubukov's house to seek help, and Chubukov has assisted him in the past, what can be inferred about their relationship? (1)

- | | |
|---------------------------|------------------------------|
| A. They are strangers | B. They are acquaintances |
| C. They are close friends | D. They are business partner |

7. Read and answer the questions for any one of the two given extracts:

Clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon,
With a clatter and a clank and a jangling squirm,
He went at the pirate like a robin at a worm.
The pirate gaped at Belinda's dragon,
And gulped some grog from his pocket flagon,
He fired two bullets, but they didn't hit,
And Custard gobbled him, every bit.

I. What literary device is used in the line "snorting like an engine"? (1)

A. Metaphor B. Simile C. Personification D. Hyperbole

II. Fill in the blank: The phrase "clashed his tail like irons in a dungeon" creates an image of Custard's movement as _____. (1)

A. slow and gentle B. sudden and violent C. stealthy and silent D. awkward and clumsy

III. What does the comparison of Custard to "a robin at a worm" suggest about his attitude towards the pirate? (1)

A. Fear and hesitation B. Indifference and boredom C. Hunger and aggression
D. Friendship and loyalty

IV. What tone does the poet convey through the pirate's actions, such as gulping grog and firing bullets? (1)

A. Confidence and bravery B. Fear and desperation
C. Amusement and playfulness D. Boredom and indifference

V. What message does the poem convey through Custard's victory over the pirate?

A. Bravery comes in unexpected forms B. Pirates are always victorious
C. Dragons are harmless creatures D. Children should fear dragons

(OR)

"The way a crow
Shook down on me
The dust of snow
From a hemlock tree
Has given my heart
A change of mood
And saved some part
Of a day I had rued"

I. What literary device is used in the line "The way a crow Shook down on me"? (1)

- A. Metaphor B. Simile C. Personification D. Imagery

II. The phrase "Has given my heart A change of mood" suggests that the speaker experienced. (1)

- A. Emotional numbness B. Spiritual awakening
C. Sudden joy D. Temporary relief

III. What does the image of the hemlock tree convey in the poem? (1)

- A. Danger and toxicity B. Peace and serenity
C. Life and vitality D. Decay and rot

IV. The poem's tone can be described as. (1)

- A. Melancholic and introspective B. Joyful and celebratory
C. Calm and contemplative D. Angry and turbulent

V. What message does the poem convey through the speaker's encounter with nature? (1)

- A. Nature's beauty can transform our mood B. Human connection is more important than nature
C. Life is fleeting, and unpredictable D. Solitude is essential for happiness

8) Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words. (4x3=12 Marks)

I. If the trees are moving out of the house and into the forest, what can be inferred about the speaker's emotional state and their relationship with the natural world? (Trees)

II. What inference can be made about the societal norms and expectations of women in Valli's community based on the story? (Madam Rides A Bus)

III. What inference can be drawn about the postmaster's character from his decision to deliver the letter despite initial doubts? (A Letter to God)

IV. What values can be inferred from Mandela's leadership and actions? (Nelson Mandela- Long Walk to Freedom)

V. How does the speaker's use of ironic instructions contribute to the poem's overall effect? (How to Tell Wild Animals)

9 Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words. (2x3=6 Marks)

- I. How does Mathilde's perception of her life change throughout the story? (The Necklace) II. What motivates Richard E. Bright to pursue science? What inference can be made about his character? (The Making of a Scientist)
- III. What drives Anil to steal? What inference can be made about his socioeconomic situation? (The Thief's Story)

10 Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words (6 Marks)

- I. Analyze the theme of loss and separation in "The Ball Poem". How does the poet use imagery, symbolism, and tone to convey the emotional impact of losing something precious? Support your answer with relevant quotes and examples from the text.
- II Examine the character of the Buddha in "The Sermon at Benares" as a symbol of spiritual awakening. What message do you think the author is conveying through the Buddha's teachings? How does the sermon impact the listeners, and what does this reveal about the human condition? Use textual evidence to support your argument. '

11 Answer any one of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words. (6 Marks)

- I Examine the role of Tricki as a symbol of companionship and emotional support in "Triumph of Surgery". How does James Herriot use Tricki's character to highlight the human-animal bond?
- II How does the author use suspense and tension to explore the blurred lines between reality and fantasy? Use textual evidence to support your argument in "Midnight Visitor".